

Finance Jobs Decoded: Markets, Banking, Risk & Advisory

What Employers Actually Want — Decoded from Real 2026 Job Postings (India-first)

Role by role: responsibilities, skills, tools, certifications, ATS keywords, salary bands & how to break in

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How Front-Office & Markets Finance Hiring Works

Before we decode individual roles, you need the map. "Finance" is not one job market — it is at least three, stacked by prestige, pay and difficulty of entry. If you understand which layer a posting belongs to, you can read any job description in seconds and know whether it is a realistic target, a stretch, or a trap. This chapter builds that map for the Indian market as it looks in mid-2026.

Buy-side vs sell-side vs support

Everything in markets finance sits on one of three sides.

Sell-side firms *make and sell* financial products, research and advice. Investment banks (Citi, Kotak, Axis Capital, JM Financial), broking houses and their equity-research desks (Equirus, Motilal Oswal, ICICI Securities) are sell-side. They raise capital, execute M&A, publish research and trade. Sell-side is where most graduates start, because it hires in volume and trains hard. The price is brutal hours.

Buy-side firms *manage money* — mutual funds, PMS, hedge funds, private equity, venture capital, insurance and pension pools (SBI MF, HDFC AMC, ICICI Prudential, sovereign and PE funds). They *buy* what the sell-side sells. Buy-side seats are fewer, quieter, better paid over a career, and much harder to enter directly. Many people spend 2-4 years sell-side, then cross over.

Support / middle-and-back office keeps the machine legal, funded and reconciled: risk, treasury, KYC/AML, compliance, GRC, fund accounting, operations. Global capability centres (GCCs) of Citi, Barclays, Deutsche, Northern Trust, Wells Fargo, plus KPOs like Acuity and Genpact, hire thousands of these roles across Mumbai, Bangalore, Hyderabad, Pune and Gurgaon. This is, realistically, where the largest number of commerce and MBA-Finance graduates actually get in — and several of those roles pay well and lead somewhere.

The honest hierarchy of pay and exclusivity runs roughly: front-office buy-side > front-office sell-side (IB) > specialist risk/quant > equity research / credit > treasury / FP&A > operations / KYC / compliance. But "prestige" and "good career" are not the same thing — a risk analyst at a GCC can out-earn a burnt-out IB associate over ten years, with a life.

The bar: pedigree, skills, certification

Front-office finance is one of the few Indian white-collar markets that still openly filters on **pedigree**. Bulge-bracket IB and top equity-research desks disproportionately recruit from a short list of target schools — the IIMs, ISB, FMS, XLRI, SPJIMR, JBIMS — plus CAs with strong ranks. If you are not from that list, you are not locked out, but you must compensate with demonstrable **skill** and a **side door** (more on that below).

Three things move the needle everywhere:

- **Modelling ability.** The three-statement model, DCF, comparable-company and precedent-transaction analysis, LBO. Front-office interviews *test* this live — you will be handed a case or an Excel screen.
- **Certifications** — but role-specific ones, not a scattershot alphabet soup. The CFA charter is the near-universal signal for research, buy-side and credit. FRM/PRM is the risk badge. NISM series are *legally required* for many Indian markets roles (research analyst, investment adviser, dealing). CA is gold for credit, controllership and anything statements-heavy. ACAMS helps for KYC/AML. FMVA is a useful self-starter modelling credential for non-target candidates, though it carries far less weight than CFA.

- **A track record you can show** — a stock pitch, a real model, a research note, a covenant analysis. This is what lets a non-target candidate leapfrog the pedigree filter.

The roles this book covers

This book decodes the front-office and markets-adjacent roles, each in its own chapter:

Cluster	Roles covered
Advisory	Investment Banking Analyst
Research	Equity Research Analyst
Credit & lending	Credit Analyst (Corporate & Retail)
Risk & quant	Credit Risk, Model Validation / Quant Risk
Markets ops	Treasury Analyst
Financial crime & control	KYC/AML Analyst, Compliance, GRC / IT Risk
Investing	Private Equity / Investment Analyst, Wealth
Corporate	Corporate Finance / FP&A adjacencies

Read across them and you will notice the same skills recombining: financial-statement analysis, modelling, a valuation or risk framework, a compliance overlay, and Excel as the universal solvent.

Realistic entry paths from an MBA-Finance or commerce start

You will not usually walk from a B.Com straight into a bulge-bracket IB seat. Here are the paths that actually work.

1. **Target MBA / CA route (the front door).** Land on a campus that the front-office firms visit, ace the modelling and technicals, convert a summer internship into a pre-placement offer. Fastest but gated by the admit.
2. **KPO / GCC route (the side door — most common).** Start at Acuity, Evalueserve, Moody's Analytics, WNS, Genpact, or a bank's GCC doing research support, credit analysis, fund accounting or risk. Build a real skill, then move up or lateral into the parent's front office or a buy-side firm. This route is under-glamorised and highly effective.
3. **Cert-plus-portfolio route (the non-target's crowbar).** Clear CFA Level I-II or NISM-RA, publish 2-3 genuinely good stock pitches or credit notes on a blog/Substack, and cold-apply to boutiques and smaller AMCs that hire on demonstrated ability, not brand.
4. **Adjacent-then-pivot.** Enter via audit (a Big Four CA), FP&A, or treasury, then pivot into research or credit once you have statements fluency and a network.

An honest note on competitiveness and pay

Front-office finance is genuinely hard to enter and, at the top, genuinely lucrative — a good IB analyst or buy-side associate can out-earn most professions in India within five years. But the funnel is narrow, the hours (in IB and research) can be punishing, and "finance" salaries in job ads are wildly bimodal: an SME

accounts role at Rs 3-4 LPA and a bulge-bracket IB analyst at Rs 20-30 LPA both appear under "finance jobs." This book keeps salary bands honest, per role, so you know which end of the barbell you are aiming at — and what it will actually take to get there.

Investment Banking Analyst

Snapshot

The Investment Banking (IB) Analyst is the engine room of a deal team. You sit in the Investment Banking Division (IBD) of a bank — bulge-bracket names like Citi, J.P. Morgan and Goldman in Mumbai, or domestic powerhouses like Kotak Investment Banking, Axis Capital, JM Financial and Avendus — and you build the models, decks and analysis that let senior bankers advise companies on raising capital and buying or selling businesses. It is the most prestigious, best-paid and most punishing entry point in markets finance. The ladder is steep and well-defined: **Analyst (2-3 yrs) -> Associate -> Vice President (VP) -> Director / Senior VP -> Managing Director (MD)**. The Analyst does the work; the MD wins the mandate. In India, the Analyst tier is often split into Analyst 1/2/3, and many analysts leave after 2-3 years for private equity, a top MBA, or a corporate strategy role — the classic "two and out."

What you'll actually do

Grounded on Citi's Mumbai IBD Analyst posting, the real day-to-day is:

- Build and maintain **complex financial and valuation models** — three-statement operating models, DCF, comparable-company and precedent-transaction analysis, accretion/dilution and LBO models.
- Support **capital-raising** transactions (IPOs, QIPs, rights issues, debt) and **M&A / strategic advisory** mandates end to end.
- Prepare **pitchbooks and pitch materials** — the decks used to win and execute mandates — including valuation and statistical exhibits.
- Conduct **economic, industry and company research**; assemble the data room and information memoranda for live deals.
- Run comps, precedent-transaction screens and sensitivity tables; sanity-check every number partners will put in front of a client.

Real posting (Citi): "Build complex financial and valuation models and prepare pitch materials, valuation and statistical exhibits, and economic and financial research to support capital raising and M&A/strategic advisory."

The unglamorous truth: much of year one is formatting decks, chasing data, and turning comments at midnight. Attention to detail is not a nice-to-have — a wrong cell in a model shown to a board is a career event.

Must-have skills

Hard skills: financial modelling (three-statement, DCF, LBO, M&A), valuation, accounting fluency (you must read a balance sheet and cash-flow statement cold), corporate-finance theory, and elite Excel and PowerPoint craft. **Soft skills:** extreme attention to detail, stamina under deadline pressure, the ability to take heavy feedback without flinching, clear written communication, and discretion around confidential deals.

Tools & software

Excel (the primary weapon — modelling is done here), PowerPoint (pitchbooks), and data terminals: **Bloomberg, Capital IQ, FactSet, Refinitiv/Eikon**. Deal and data-room platforms (Datasite/Merrill, Ansarada), plus PitchBook/Prowess/Ace Equity for Indian company data. VBA and increasingly Python for automation are a bonus, not a requirement.

Qualifications & certifications

The realistic entry credential is a **top-tier MBA (IIM-A/B/C, ISB, FMS, XLRI, SPJIMR, JBIMS)** or a strong-rank **CA**, ideally paired with a summer internship converted to a pre-placement offer. Bulge-bracket IBD in India is openly target-school biased. The **CFA charter** is a strong signal, especially for non-MBA or non-target candidates, and demonstrates the exact valuation knowledge the job needs. **FMVA** or a hands-on modelling course helps a non-target candidate prove the skill but does not substitute for pedigree. A bachelor's alone is the *stated* minimum but rarely enough at the bulge bracket.

Experience & typical titles

Rung	Experience	Typical titles
Entry	0-3 yrs	Analyst, IB Analyst, IBD Analyst
Mid	3-6 yrs	Associate, Sr Associate
Senior	6-10 yrs	Vice President
Leadership	10 yrs+	Director / SVP, Managing Director

The Citi posting cites 2-5 years — that maps to Analyst-into-Associate. Genuine freshers usually enter only through campus/internship pipelines.

ATS keywords to mirror

Financial modelling, valuation, DCF, LBO, comparable company analysis, precedent transactions, M&A, capital raising, pitchbooks, pitch materials, three-statement model, accretion dilution, equity capital markets, debt capital markets, due diligence, information memorandum, Bloomberg, Capital IQ, FactSet, Excel, PowerPoint, CFA, corporate finance.

Salary in India (indicative, FY2026)

Experience band	Indicative CTC (Rs LPA)
Fresher / Analyst 1	14 - 24
2-4 yrs (Analyst 2-3 / Associate)	24 - 45
5-8 yrs (VP track)	45 - 90+

Wide ranges reflect the gap between domestic boutiques and bulge brackets, and the fact that **bonus can equal or exceed base**. Figures are approximate and vary by firm, city (Mumbai commands the premium) and

deal year.

Who's hiring

Bulge brackets and global banks in Mumbai (**Citi**, J.P. Morgan, Goldman Sachs, Morgan Stanley, Bank of America, Nomura), domestic full-service banks (**Kotak**, **Axis Capital**, **ICICI Securities**, **SBI Capital**), independent advisors (**JM Financial**, **Avendus**, **Ambit**, **o3 Capital**), and Big Four deal-advisory arms. GCCs also run large IB support and M&A analytics teams in Bangalore, Mumbai and Pune.

How to break in / stand out

The clean path is a target-school MBA or ranked CA, a summer IBD internship, and converting it. If you are outside that funnel, your crowbar is **demonstrated modelling skill**: build a fully-linked three-statement model plus a DCF and a comps set for a real listed Indian company, write a tight two-page investment thesis, and carry it as a portfolio. Clear at least CFA Level I. Network relentlessly into boutiques and mid-market advisors, which hire more on ability than brand. **The single biggest differentiator is a clean, auditable model you built yourself** — nothing else so quickly convinces a banker you can survive the desk. Be honest with yourself about the hours: 80-100 hour weeks are real, and the two-and-out exit to PE, a global MBA, or corp-dev is the goal most analysts are actually optimising for.

Equity Research Analyst

Snapshot

An Equity Research (ER) Analyst forms and defends a view on whether a stock is worth buying. You cover a **sector** (say IT services, banks, cement or FMCG), build models of every company in it, and publish notes with a rating and a target price. There are two worlds. **Sell-side** research — at broking houses and banks like Equirus, Motilal Oswal, ICICI Securities, Kotak Institutional Equities, Nuvama — is published for institutional clients (mutual funds, FII) to win their trading and banking business. **Buy-side** research — inside AMCs, hedge funds and PMS shops — is internal, feeds the fund's own portfolio decisions, and is never published. The sell-side ladder runs **Associate -> Analyst -> Senior Analyst -> Lead Analyst (sector head) -> Head of Research**. Buy-side runs Analyst -> Senior Analyst -> Fund Manager. Many people build a track record sell-side and cross to the better-paid, quieter buy-side.

What you'll actually do

Grounded on the Equirus (Mumbai/Ahmedabad) posting, the real work is:

- Run **channel checks** — talk to dealers, distributors, suppliers, ex-employees and industry contacts to get ground-truth on demand, pricing and competition.
- Translate those insights into **detailed financial models**: revenue drivers, margins, working capital, and a valuation (DCF, P/E, EV/EBITDA, sum-of-the-parts).
- Publish **stock initiations** (the first deep report on a company) and ongoing **investment ideas**, each with a rating and target price.
- Write **research reports for institutional investors** — the note *is* the product, so writing is as important as the numbers.
- Track quarterly results, model the beats/misses, host and attend management and analyst calls, and defend your call when the stock moves against you.

Real posting (Equirus): "Conduct channel checks and translate insights into financial models to analyse margins and valuation; produce stock initiations and investment ideas in reports for institutional investors."

Must-have skills

Hard skills: financial-statement analysis, sector and company modelling, valuation (DCF, relative multiples, SOTP), and above all **report writing** — the ability to argue a thesis crisply on two pages. **Soft skills:** independent conviction (you must be willing to be contrarian and be *right*), curiosity and hustle for channel checks, communication with fund managers and management teams, and the emotional steadiness to hold a call when the market disagrees.

Tools & software

Excel (modelling), Bloomberg and Refinitiv/Eikon (data, estimates, calls), Capital IQ / FactSet, and Indian databases like **Ace Equity, Prowess (CMIE) and Screener**. PowerPoint/Word for notes; increasingly Python

or Power BI for data-heavy sector work. Access to management, conferences and expert networks (Tegus, GLG) is part of the "toolset."

Qualifications & certifications

An **MBA-Finance** or **CA** is the standard base, and the Equirus posting asks for an MBA. The **CFA charter** is arguably the single most valued credential in research — it maps directly onto the job and is close to a default expectation on the buy-side. Critically, to publish research in India you (or your firm) must comply with SEBI's Research Analyst regulations, which makes the **NISM-Series-XV: Research Analyst certification** effectively mandatory for a practising sell-side RA. NISM-Series-VIII (Equity Derivatives) and the CFA/CFP suite help for adjacent buy-side roles.

Experience & typical titles

Rung	Experience	Typical titles
Entry	0-3 yrs	Research Associate, Junior Analyst
Mid	3-7 yrs	Equity Research Analyst, Sector Analyst
Senior	7-12 yrs	Senior/Lead Analyst, Sector Head
Leadership	12 yrs+	Head of Research, Fund Manager (buy-side)

The Equirus posting's 4-7 years targets an analyst who can independently own a sector, not a fresher. Freshers usually start as associates supporting a senior analyst.

ATS keywords to mirror

Equity research, financial modelling, valuation, DCF, relative valuation, EV/EBITDA, channel checks, stock initiation, target price, sector coverage, earnings model, institutional investors, buy-side, sell-side, research report writing, Bloomberg, Capital IQ, Ace Equity, CFA, NISM Research Analyst, investment thesis.

Salary in India (indicative, FY2026)

Experience band	Indicative CTC (Rs LPA)
Fresher / Associate	8 - 16
2-4 yrs	16 - 30
5-8 yrs (Analyst / Sr Analyst)	30 - 60+

Buy-side seats and star sell-side analysts sit at the top of these ranges; KPO research-support roles (Acuity, Evalueserve) sit lower. Approximate and varies by firm, city and whether the seat is publishing or support.

Who's hiring

Sell-side desks: **Equirus**, Motilal Oswal, ICICI Securities, Kotak Institutional Equities, Nuvama, Antique, JM Financial. Buy-side: AMCs (SBI MF, HDFC AMC, ICICI Prudential, Nippon), PMS and hedge funds. Research

KPOs: **Acuity Knowledge Partners, Evalueserve, Moody's Analytics, WNS** — the highest-volume entry point in India.

How to break in / stand out

Pick one sector and go deep. Build full models for 3-4 companies in it and publish **genuine stock pitches** — a clear thesis, valuation, catalysts and risks — on a blog, Substack or the CFA Society's research challenge. Clear CFA Level I-II and, if you want to publish, the NISM-RA. The KPO route (Acuity, Evalueserve) is an honest, effective side door: get in on research support, build modelling reps, then lateral to a publishing desk or buy-side. **The single biggest differentiator is a written, dated, verifiable investment call that turned out right** — a track record beats a resume line every time, and report-writing quality is what separates an analyst from a spreadsheet operator.

Credit Analyst (Corporate & Retail)

Snapshot

A Credit Analyst answers one question for a lender: *will this borrower pay us back, and on what terms?* You analyse a borrower's financials, judge the risk, and write a recommendation that decides whether a loan is approved, priced and structured — or declined. The role splits by borrower type. **Corporate / wholesale credit** underwrites large companies, financial institutions, PSUs and sovereigns — deep, judgement-heavy analysis of a handful of big exposures (the work at Barclays, Deutsche Bank, DBS, Northern Trust and MODIFI's trade-finance desk). **Retail / SME credit** underwrites individuals and small businesses at scale, leaning more on scorecards, bureau data and policy. The ladder runs **Analyst -> Senior Analyst -> Assistant Manager / Manager -> Credit Manager -> Head of Credit / Chief Credit Officer**. It is one of the most transferable skill sets in finance — the statements fluency you build here powers moves into research, risk and lending leadership.

What you'll actually do

Grounded on the Barclays (Mumbai) credit-analysis posting and peers at Deutsche, DBS and Northern Trust:

- Perform **credit analysis and due diligence** across Corporate, Financial Institution, PSU and Sovereign counterparties.
- Analyse **financial statements, cash flows, leverage and profitability**, plus industry and business-model trends, to gauge repayment capacity.
- Write **credit proposals and recommendation notes** with a clear rating and rationale that go to a credit committee for sanction.
- Assess and structure **covenants and collateral**; set limits, pricing and conditions.
- **Monitor** the existing portfolio for emerging risks — covenant breaches, rating migration, sector stress — and flag early-warning signals.
- Ensure every decision adheres to **credit policy and regulatory** requirements (RBI norms, internal risk appetite).

Real posting (Barclays): "Undertake credit analysis and due diligence for Corporate/FI/PSU/Sovereign counterparties, prepare credit proposals and recommendation notes, and analyse financial statements, cash flows, leverage, profitability and industry trends."

Must-have skills

Hard skills: financial-statement analysis, ratio and cash-flow analysis, credit-risk assessment, industry analysis, covenant and collateral structuring, and knowledge of rating methodology and RBI/regulatory norms. Retail credit adds bureau (CIBIL/CRIF) and scorecard fluency. **Soft skills:** sound judgement under uncertainty, the ability to write a persuasive, defensible credit note, attention to detail, and the spine to recommend "no" when the numbers say no.

Tools & software

Excel (spreading and modelling — the core tool), Word and PowerPoint for proposals. Data and rating platforms: **Bloomberg, Capital IQ, Refinitiv, Moody's/CRISIL/ICRA** reports, and **credit bureaus (CIBIL, CRIF, Experian)** for retail. Banks run internal rating models, loan-origination systems (LOS) and workflow tools; MODIFI-style fintechs use their own trade-finance and underwriting platforms.

Qualifications & certifications

A **CA** is exceptionally well-suited — statements analysis is its home turf — as is an **MBA-Finance**. The **CFA charter** signals strong valuation and analysis depth; the **FRM** is the natural risk credential and increasingly valued on wholesale desks. For those specialising, **CCP/credit-specific** certifications and NISM modules help at the margins. The Barclays JD lists MBA/CA/CFA/FRM as desirable — any one clears the bar; the combination stands out. A commerce bachelor's with strong analytics can enter retail/SME credit.

Experience & typical titles

Rung	Experience	Typical titles
Entry	0-2 yrs	Credit Analyst, Credit Underwriter
Mid	2-5 yrs	Senior Credit Analyst, Asst Manager - Credit
Senior	5-8 yrs	Credit Manager, Risk Manager
Leadership	8 yrs+	Head of Credit, Chief Credit Officer

Freshers commonly enter via bank GCCs, NBFCs or KPO credit-support desks; corporate/wholesale seats usually want 2-5 years plus a relevant qualification.

ATS keywords to mirror

Credit analysis, financial statement analysis, cash flow analysis, credit underwriting, credit proposal, due diligence, leverage, profitability, covenant, collateral, credit rating, risk assessment, portfolio monitoring, early warning signals, RBI regulations, credit policy, CIBIL, corporate credit, SME credit, working capital, CA, CFA, FRM.

Salary in India (indicative, FY2026)

Experience band	Indicative CTC (Rs LPA)
Fresher	5 - 10
2-4 yrs	10 - 20
5-8 yrs	20 - 40+

Corporate/wholesale credit at foreign banks and their GCCs pays at the top of these bands; retail/SME and NBFC roles sit lower. Approximate and varies by employer type, city and borrower segment.

Who's hiring

Foreign and global banks and their GCCs (**Barclays, Deutsche Bank, DBS, Northern Trust, HSBC, Standard Chartered, Citi**), Indian banks (HDFC, ICICI, Axis, SBI), NBFCs and HFCs (Bajaj Finance, L&T Finance, Tata Capital), fintech lenders and trade-finance platforms (**MODIFI**), and rating agencies (CRISIL, ICRA, CARE) for the analysis-adjacent version of the role. KPOs (Acuity, Moody's Analytics) run large credit-support teams.

How to break in / stand out

Learn to **spread a set of financials cold** — take a listed Indian company's annual report, build a ratio and cash-flow analysis, and write a one-page credit note with a rating recommendation, covenants and key risks. That single artifact demonstrates exactly what the desk does. Add CA or an MBA-Finance, and stack a CFA or FRM to signal depth. The bank-GCC and KPO route is the most reliable entry: get in on credit support or portfolio monitoring, then move to underwriting and larger exposures. **The single biggest differentiator is judgement you can evidence** — a credit note where you said "no" (or "yes, but structure it this way") and were right — because credit is ultimately a decision-making job, not a spreadsheet job.

Credit Risk Analyst

Snapshot

A Credit Risk Analyst decides, in effect, whether a lender should extend money to a borrower and on what terms — then keeps watching that exposure until it is repaid. You sit inside the risk function of a bank, NBFC, or rating/analytics firm, deliberately separate from the sales/relationship teams whose deals you scrutinise. Your raw material is financial statements, cash flows, industry data and management quality; your output is a written credit view — an approve, decline, or "approve with covenants" recommendation that a credit committee relies on. In wholesale/corporate banking (the Barclays-style desk), you analyse Corporate, Financial-Institution (FI), PSU and Sovereign counterparties. The ladder typically runs Analyst -> Senior Analyst -> Assistant Manager / Assistant Vice President -> Manager / Vice President -> Credit Head / Chief Risk Officer. It is one of the most intellectually respected seats in finance because a single bad call, scaled across a portfolio, can sink a book.

What you'll actually do

- Perform credit analysis and due diligence on borrowers across Corporate, FI, PSU and Sovereign segments — reading annual reports, management accounts and rating rationales.
- Write credit proposals and recommendation notes: the structured document that goes to the sanctioning authority with your rating, exposure limit, and conditions.
- Spread and analyse financial statements — profitability, leverage (debt/EBITDA, gearing), interest cover, liquidity ratios, and multi-year cash-flow trends.
- Assess repayment capacity and debt-servicing under base and stress scenarios; flag covenant breaches early.
- Monitor emerging risks in the existing portfolio — sector downturns, rating downgrades, delayed receivables, promoter/governance red flags — and escalate before they become NPAs.
- Ensure every decision adheres to internal credit policy and regulatory norms (RBI prudential norms, exposure limits, IRAC classification).
- Build exhibits and summaries in Excel/Word/PowerPoint for the credit committee.

Real posting (Barclays): "Undertake credit analysis and due diligence for Corporate, FI, PSU and Sovereign counterparties and prepare credit proposals and recommendation notes."

Must-have skills

Hard skills: financial-statement analysis (the core craft), ratio and cash-flow analysis, understanding of leverage and working-capital cycles, industry/sector analysis, and knowledge of credit policy plus RBI regulatory framework. You must be able to model a borrower's ability to service debt and translate numbers into a clear risk narrative. Soft skills the JDs repeatedly demand: sharp written communication (a recommendation note is only as good as its argument), sound judgement under incomplete information, attention to detail, and the spine to say "no" or attach conditions when a relationship manager is pushing a deal. Scepticism is a feature, not a flaw.

Tools & software

- **Excel** — spreading statements, ratio models, sensitivity/stress tables (non-negotiable).
- **Word & PowerPoint** — proposal notes and committee decks.
- Rating-agency and data platforms: **CRISIL / ICRA / CARE** reports, **Bloomberg, Refinitiv/Capital IQ** for financials and peer data.
- Internal rating models / credit-scoring engines and loan-origination systems (bank-specific).
- **MCA / probe databases** for due diligence on Indian corporates.

Qualifications & certifications

Degree: a bachelor's is the floor; most competitive candidates hold an **MBA-Finance, CA, or CFA**. For this role specifically: - **CA** — strongest signal for reading and trusting financial statements; heavily favoured by Indian banks and NBFCs. - **MBA-Finance** — the standard entry route into corporate/wholesale credit. - **CFA** — well regarded for the analytical and valuation depth, especially at global banks. - **FRM** — desirable, and increasingly expected as you move toward portfolio and policy roles. The Barclays posting explicitly lists MBA/CA/CFA/FRM as desirable — treat any one as your ticket in, and a second as your differentiator.

Experience & typical titles

Band	Typical title	What's expected
Fresher (0-2 yrs)	Credit Analyst, Credit Risk Analyst	Spread statements, draft note sections, portfolio monitoring
2-5 yrs	Senior Analyst, Assistant Manager, AVP	Own end-to-end proposals, defend views to committee
5-8 yrs	Manager / VP, Credit Manager	Sign-off authority, sector coverage, mentor analysts
8+ yrs	Credit Head, Chief Risk Officer track	Policy, portfolio strategy, regulatory interface

ATS keywords to mirror

Credit analysis, credit risk, due diligence, credit proposals, recommendation notes, financial statement analysis, cash flow analysis, leverage, profitability, debt servicing, working capital, credit policy, regulatory compliance, RBI norms, corporate credit, FI, PSU, sovereign, portfolio monitoring, emerging risk, rating, covenant, Excel, CRISIL, CFA, FRM, CA, MBA Finance.

Salary in India (indicative, FY2026)

Experience band	Indicative range (Rs LPA)
Fresher (0-2 yrs)	5 - 9
2-4 yrs	9 - 16
5-8 yrs	16 - 30+

Approximate; varies materially by employer type (global bank > private bank > NBFC > rating firm KPO) and city (Mumbai commands the premium).

Who's hiring

- **Global/foreign banks:** Barclays, Citi, HSBC, Standard Chartered, Deutsche Bank — wholesale and counterparty credit desks (mostly Mumbai/Bengaluru).
- **Indian private banks & NBFCs:** HDFC, ICICI, Axis, Kotak, Bajaj Finance — corporate and mid-market credit.
- **Rating agencies:** CRISIL, ICRA, CARE — credit analysis at scale.
- **Analytics/KPO firms:** Acuity, Moody's Analytics, S&P Global — offshore credit-analysis teams supporting global banks.

How to break in / stand out

For a commerce/MBA-Finance candidate, the fastest credible route is to *demonstrate you can read a balance sheet like a detective*. Build a portfolio of 3-4 **real credit notes**: pick listed Indian companies from different sectors, spread three years of financials, compute leverage/coverage/liquidity ratios, and write a one-page recommendation ("would you lend Rs 100 cr for 5 years — and why/why not"). Include one distressed case (say, a company that later defaulted) and show whether the numbers gave early warning. This single artifact beats a page of certifications because it proves the actual job.

Layer on the credentials that build trust in your numbers — CA or CFA Level I/II — and learn RBI's IRAC/provisioning norms cold, because Indian credit is regulation-shaped. **The single biggest differentiator is judgement expressed in writing**: two analysts can compute the same ratios, but the one who can argue a crisp, defensible "approve with these three covenants" gets promoted. Practise writing tight, opinionated credit views, and be honest — this role rewards the person willing to be the unpopular "no" in the room.

Risk Analyst (Market, Operational & Model Risk)

Snapshot

This is the quantitative wing of the risk function — the people who measure how much a bank or fund could lose from moving markets, broken processes, or fraud, and who check that the models used to make those measurements are actually sound. Unlike a credit analyst (who judges one borrower), a market/model-risk analyst thinks in distributions: Value-at-Risk, expected shortfall, factor sensitivities, backtesting. A large slice of these jobs today is **model validation** — independently reviewing the pricing and risk models built by front-office quants and model developers, against the firm's model-risk policy, so regulators and management can trust the numbers. You'll find these seats at global banks (Societe Generale, Barclays, Deutsche) and, very heavily, at analytics firms like **Acuity** that run offshore model-validation and risk-analytics teams. Ladder: Analyst -> Senior Analyst -> AVP/Manager -> VP -> Head of Model Risk / Market Risk.

What you'll actually do

- Validate and independently review models — pricing, VaR, credit, and increasingly ML models — against the firm's model-risk management policy.
- Build and test **VaR, multi-factor risk models, time-series models and optimization** routines; check assumptions, data quality and limitations.
- **Backtest** risk models: compare predicted losses vs realised, count exceptions, and document breaches.
- Cover multiple risk types — market, operational, and fraud risk — measuring and monitoring exposures and limits.
- Write validation reports and model-governance documentation that stands up to internal audit and regulators (RBI, and global standards like SR 11-7).
- Investigate model failures and edge cases; recommend remediation, re-calibration, or additional conservatism.
- Pull and cleanse data from market-data vendors and feed it into risk engines.

Real posting (Acuity): "Perform model validation and review against the model-risk policy — covering VaR, multi-factor risk models, time-series, optimization and machine-learning techniques."

Must-have skills

Hard skills: solid grounding in statistics and probability, VaR/expected-shortfall methodology, time-series analysis, factor models and optimization, and a working understanding of derivatives and their risk sensitivities (the Greeks). Increasingly, familiarity with **machine-learning** techniques and how to validate them. Programming is central — you must be able to reproduce and stress a model yourself, not just read someone's memo. Soft skills: precise technical writing (validation reports are read by skeptical auditors), independence of mind, and the diplomacy to challenge front-office quants without a turf war.

Tools & software

- **Programming/analytics:** Python, R, SAS, MATLAB, SQL, VBA — the Acuity stack lists most of these.
- **Market-data platforms:** Bloomberg, Refinitiv (Eikon), MSCI (Barra/RiskMetrics), Markit, Capital IQ.
- **Excel** for prototyping and reconciliation; internal risk engines and model libraries.
- Version control and documentation tooling for model inventory/governance.

Qualifications & certifications

Degree: a **master's in a quantitative discipline** (financial engineering, statistics, maths, economics, physics) is the typical expectation — this is a quant-leaning seat. Certifications that genuinely move the needle: - **FRM (GARP)** — the most directly relevant; it is the market/operational-risk syllabus. - **PRM** — similar positioning, well regarded in model risk. - **CFA** — helps with the finance/valuation context, complements FRM. - **CQF** — useful if you're pushing toward the modelling/derivatives-heavy end. A quant master's + FRM (or in progress) is the standard "credible candidate" combination here.

Experience & typical titles

Band	Typical title	What's expected
Fresher (0-2 yrs)	Risk Analyst, Model Validation Analyst	Support validations, run backtests, data prep
2-5 yrs	Senior Risk Analyst, AVP, Model Validation Associate	Own full validations, write reports, cover a model class
5-8 yrs	VP / Manager, Lead Validator	Sign-off, methodology, regulator interface
8+ yrs	Head of Model Risk / Market Risk	Framework, governance, firm-wide model inventory

Acuity's posting targets the 3-5 year band, which is the sweet spot for offshore validation roles.

ATS keywords to mirror

Model validation, model risk, VaR, value at risk, expected shortfall, multi-factor models, time-series, backtesting, market risk, operational risk, fraud risk, model governance, optimization, machine learning, Python, R, SAS, SQL, MATLAB, VBA, Bloomberg, Refinitiv, MSCI, Markit, FRM, PRM, CFA, derivatives, Greeks, stress testing, SR 11-7.

Salary in India (indicative, FY2026)

Experience band	Indicative range (Rs LPA)
Fresher (0-2 yrs)	7 - 12
2-4 yrs	12 - 22
5-8 yrs	22 - 40+

Approximate; quant-heavy roles at global banks pay above analytics-firm bands, and Mumbai/Bengaluru lead. Strong Python + FRM lifts offers noticeably.

Who's hiring

- **Analytics/KPO firms:** Acuity Knowledge Partners, Moody's Analytics, S&P Global, CRISIL GR&A — large offshore model-validation and risk teams (Bengaluru, Gurugram).
- **Global banks' GCCs:** Societe Generale, Barclays, Deutsche Bank, HSBC, Nomura, Morgan Stanley — market-risk and model-risk desks in India.
- **Consulting:** the Big Four risk-advisory practices for model-risk and validation projects.

How to break in / stand out

For a commerce/MBA-Finance candidate this is the hardest jump in this book, because the bar is genuinely quantitative — be honest with yourself about the maths. The realistic bridge is to **layer quant skills onto your finance base**: get comfortable with Python (pandas, numpy, statsmodels), learn the statistics behind VaR and time-series, and start FRM. Then build proof: implement a **VaR model on a real portfolio in Python** — historical, parametric, and Monte-Carlo methods — and **backtest it**, counting exceptions over a stressed period like a market crash, exactly as a validator would. Write it up as a short validation report with assumptions, limitations and a recommendation. That artifact directly mirrors the day job.

The single biggest differentiator is the combination of finance domain plus code: firms are flooded with people who know one or the other. Someone who can both explain *why* a model understates tail risk and *rewrite it in Python to prove it* is rare and instantly hireable. If pure maths isn't your strength, aim for the operational-risk and governance end of the spectrum, which rewards process rigour and clear writing more than heavy stochastic calculus.

Quantitative Analyst (Quant)

Snapshot

A Quantitative Analyst — "quant" — builds the mathematical models that price financial instruments, forecast markets, and measure risk. This is the deep end of finance, where the job is genuinely applied maths and code rather than spreadsheets and narrative. Quants split into flavours: **sell-side desk quants** at banks price and hedge derivatives and support traders; **buy-side quants** at hedge funds and quant asset managers build signals and systematic trading strategies (often called quant researchers); **risk/model quants** develop the models validators later check; and **vendor quants** at analytics firms build libraries and tools sold to the industry. Be honest up front: **the bar is high** — a strong STEM background, real programming ability, and comfort with stochastic calculus are effectively mandatory. Ladder: Junior/Associate Quant -> Quant Analyst -> Senior Quant / Quant Researcher -> VP/Lead Quant -> Head of Quant / Quant PM.

What you'll actually do

- Build and maintain **pricing models** for derivatives (options, swaps, structured products) and calibrate them to market data.
- Develop **risk models** — sensitivities (Greeks), VaR, scenario and stress engines.
- Research and prototype trading signals or systematic strategies (buy-side), and backtest them rigorously against historical data.
- Apply **stochastic calculus, PDEs, Monte-Carlo simulation, time-series econometrics and machine learning** to real financial problems.
- Write production-quality code, clean data pipelines, and validate that model output is numerically stable and correct.
- Collaborate with traders, portfolio managers or risk teams to turn a desk problem into a working model.
- Document methodology so results are reproducible and defensible.

Synthesised from real postings: build complex pricing and risk models, apply time-series and machine-learning techniques, and implement them in Python/C++ with strong software-engineering discipline.

Must-have skills

Hard skills: **stochastic calculus and probability**, differential equations, numerical methods (Monte-Carlo, finite difference), time-series analysis, optimization, and increasingly machine learning. Deep understanding of **derivatives pricing** (Black-Scholes and beyond) for pricing roles, or statistical modelling for buy-side signal work. Above all, **strong programming** — this is a coding job, not a maths quiz. Soft skills: the ability to reduce a messy real-world problem to a clean model, intellectual honesty about what a model can't do, and clear communication with non-quants (a trader must trust your number in seconds).

Tools & software

- **Python** — the lingua franca (numpy, pandas, scipy, scikit-learn, PyTorch/TensorFlow for ML quants).
- **C++** — still dominant for low-latency pricing libraries and HFT.

- **SQL** for data; sometimes R, MATLAB, or KDB+/q for tick data.
- **Bloomberg / Refinitiv** market data; internal pricing/risk libraries (QuantLib and proprietary).
- Git, Linux, and general software-engineering tooling — quants are expected to ship real code.

Qualifications & certifications

Degree: this is the one role in this book where a **master's or PhD in a quantitative field** (financial engineering, maths, physics, statistics, CS, engineering) is close to a hard requirement. A B.Com/MBA-Finance alone will rarely clear the bar without serious quantitative retooling. Certifications: - **CQF (Certificate in Quantitative Finance)** — the most targeted credential; designed exactly for this transition and respected as a signal of applied quant skill. - **FRM** — helpful for risk-quant and model roles. - **CFA** — useful context, but not what gets you a quant seat; the maths and code do. Certifications supplement, never replace, demonstrable quantitative and programming ability.

Experience & typical titles

Band	Typical title	What's expected
Entry (0-2 yrs)	Junior Quant, Quant Analyst, Quant Developer	Implement/calibrate models, build tooling under guidance
2-5 yrs	Quant Analyst, Quant Researcher, Associate	Own a model or strategy, research independently
5-8 yrs	Senior Quant, VP Quant, Lead	Design methodology, mentor, own a book/desk's models
8+ yrs	Head of Quant, Quant PM	Strategy, P&L or firm-wide model ownership

ATS keywords to mirror

Quantitative analyst, quant, pricing models, derivatives pricing, risk models, stochastic calculus, Monte Carlo, PDE, numerical methods, time series, machine learning, backtesting, Python, C++, SQL, QuantLib, Bloomberg, VaR, Greeks, optimization, systematic strategies, financial engineering, CQF, FRM, quantitative research.

Salary in India (indicative, FY2026)

Experience band	Indicative range (Rs LPA)
Entry (0-2 yrs)	12 - 25
2-4 yrs	25 - 45
5-8 yrs	45 - 90+

Approximate and wide. Buy-side/hedge-fund quant pay (with bonus) can far exceed these; bank and vendor roles cluster lower. Mumbai and Bengaluru dominate. Compensation reflects the genuinely scarce skill set.

Who's hiring

- **Global banks' GCCs / desks:** Goldman Sachs, Morgan Stanley, JPMorgan, Deutsche Bank, Nomura — desk and risk quants in Bengaluru/Mumbai.
- **Quant funds & prop shops:** WorldQuant, Tower Research, Graviton, AlphaGrep, Quadeye — buy-side and HFT research.
- **Asset managers & vendors:** quant teams at large AMCs; analytics vendors (Bloomberg, MSCI) building model libraries.
- **Analytics firms:** Acuity, S&P Global for model-development support roles.

How to break in / stand out

Be clear-eyed: for a commerce/MBA-Finance reader, breaking into a true quant role usually requires **deliberately acquiring the quantitative foundation** — either a quant master's or a serious self-study path (CQF plus real maths). Don't fake it; the interviews probe stochastic calculus and coding directly.

The portfolio that impresses is a **working quant project on GitHub**: for example, implement an options pricer in Python (Black-Scholes plus a Monte-Carlo and a binomial-tree method), calibrate it to real market quotes, and compute and hedge the Greeks — or build and honestly backtest a simple systematic strategy with proper transaction costs and out-of-sample testing. Clean, documented, reproducible code that shows you understand *both* the maths and the software matters more than any certificate.

The single biggest differentiator is provable depth: the field is full of people who took an online course, and interviewers can tell in ten minutes. The candidate who can derive a result on the whiteboard *and* has shipped correct, tested code stands apart. If the full quant bar is out of reach, the adjacent roles in this book — model validation, risk analytics, or data-heavy financial analysis — are more realistic on-ramps that still use much of the same toolkit.

Treasury Analyst

Snapshot

A Treasury Analyst manages an organisation's money itself — its cash, its bank relationships, its funding and its market exposures — so the business always has liquidity where it needs it, at the lowest cost and controlled risk. In a corporate treasury (Intel-style), you settle trades across FX, fixed income, equity and derivatives, run bank-account administration, forecast cash, and invest surplus in money markets. In a bank treasury (JPMorgan-style), the canvas is bigger — funding, liquidity ratios, and regulatory reporting. It's an operations-and-markets hybrid: part precise back-/middle-office discipline, part market awareness. The role sits between the business, the banks, and the markets. Ladder: Treasury Analyst -> Senior Treasury Analyst -> Assistant Manager / Treasury Manager -> Manager / AVP -> Treasurer / Head of Treasury.

What you'll actually do

- **Settle** transactions across FX, fixed-income, equity and derivative products — matching, confirming, and ensuring timely cash movement.
- **Bank account management:** open/close accounts, manage signatories, and run **KYC/AML** documentation with partner banks.
- Forecast **cash and liquidity** — daily positions, short-term funding needs, and surplus available to invest.
- Invest and borrow in **money markets**; support short-term credit and counterparty analysis.
- Handle **derivatives** used for hedging (FX forwards, interest-rate swaps) — capture, confirm and monitor.
- Track and report **treasury KPIs** and prepare regulatory and internal reporting.
- Reconcile bank statements and treasury records; investigate breaks.

Real posting (Intel): "Settlement of FX, fixed income, equity and derivative transactions; bank account management including KYC/AML, account openings/closings and signatory maintenance."

Must-have skills

Hard skills: understanding of **cash and liquidity management**, money markets and short-term instruments, FX and basic derivatives, and the settlement lifecycle. **KYC/AML** knowledge for bank-account work, plus strong reconciliation discipline and Excel. A grasp of how interest rates and currencies move helps you contextualise the numbers. Soft skills: precision and reliability (a missed settlement is a real, dated problem), calm under deadline pressure, and clean communication with banks and internal desks. Treasury rewards people who are both meticulous *and* commercially aware.

Tools & software

- **Treasury Management Systems (TMS):** Kyriba, FIS, or in-house platforms.
- **SAP** (including **SAP HANA / SAP Treasury**), Oracle Treasury modules — Intel's stack names SAP HANA.
- **Excel** — cash forecasting, reconciliation, KPI tracking (essential).
- **Bloomberg / Reuters** for market rates; bank portals and **SWIFT** for payments and confirmations.

Qualifications & certifications

Degree: a **finance degree** (B.Com, BBA-Finance, MBA-Finance) is the standard entry; the Intel posting asks for a finance degree with 2-3 years. Certifications that help for this specific role: - **MBA-Finance** — the common route into corporate treasury. - **CA / CMA** — valued for the accounting and controls rigour, especially in Indian corporates. - **ACT (Association of Corporate Treasurers)** qualifications — the globally recognised treasury credential; a strong differentiator as you specialise. - **CFA** — useful for the investment/money-market side. - **NISM / ACAMS** — NISM helps on the markets side; ACAMS supports the KYC/AML component.

Experience & typical titles

Band	Typical title	What's expected
Fresher (0-2 yrs)	Treasury Analyst, Treasury Executive	Settlements, recon, cash reporting support
2-4 yrs	Senior Treasury Analyst, Assistant Manager	Own cash forecasting, bank relationships, hedging support
5-8 yrs	Treasury Manager, AVP	Liquidity strategy, funding, team lead
8+ yrs	Head of Treasury / Treasurer	Capital structure, policy, board reporting

ATS keywords to mirror

Treasury, cash management, liquidity management, cash flow forecasting, settlements, FX, foreign exchange, fixed income, derivatives, money markets, bank account management, KYC, AML, reconciliation, treasury management system, TMS, SAP, SAP HANA, Kyriba, SWIFT, hedging, interest rate swaps, regulatory reporting, treasury KPIs, Excel.

Salary in India (indicative, FY2026)

Experience band	Indicative range (Rs LPA)
Fresher (0-2 yrs)	4 - 8
2-4 yrs	8 - 15
5-8 yrs	15 - 28+

Approximate; MNC captive/corporate treasuries and bank treasuries pay above domestic mid-caps, and Mumbai/Bengaluru lead. Varies by city and employer.

Who's hiring

- **MNC captives / GCCs:** Intel, and technology and manufacturing multinationals running global treasury operations from Bengaluru/Hyderabad.
- **Banks:** JPMorgan, Citi, HSBC, Deutsche Bank, and Indian banks' treasury desks.

- **Large Indian corporates:** Reliance, Tata group, infrastructure and manufacturing firms with active treasuries.
- **Shared-service / BPO providers** running treasury operations for clients.

How to break in / stand out

For a commerce/MBA-Finance candidate, treasury is one of the more *accessible* markets-adjacent careers — it prizes reliability and process mastery as much as market brilliance, so a diligent B.Com/MBA-Finance grad can genuinely enter. Start by getting fluent in **cash-flow forecasting and bank reconciliation in Excel**, and learn the settlement lifecycle (trade -> confirmation -> settlement -> reconciliation) cold. Build a small portfolio project: construct a **13-week rolling cash-flow forecast** for a hypothetical company, with a liquidity-buffer policy and a simple FX-hedging plan for a foreign receivable — this shows you think like a treasurer, not just a bookkeeper.

Layer on domain credentials as you specialise: understand **KYC/AML** basics (ACAMS-lite knowledge goes a long way given every JD lists it), and get familiar with what a **TMS/SAP Treasury** actually does. **The single biggest differentiator is dependability plus commercial awareness** — treasury runs on trust, because a single late settlement or unmanaged FX exposure has an immediate rupee cost. The analyst who never misses a cut-off *and* can explain why a hedge saved money is the one who moves up toward Treasurer.

KYC / AML Analyst

Snapshot

The KYC / AML Analyst is the person who decides whether a bank actually *knows* who its customer is — and whether that customer is safe to bank. Every regulated financial institution in the world is legally required to identify its clients, understand what they do, and screen them against sanctions, PEP (Politically Exposed Person) and adverse-media lists before and during the relationship. That legal obligation is what creates this job, and it creates it in enormous volume. In India this is the single biggest entry door into banking through the GCC (Global Capability Centre) route: Citi, HSBC, Standard Chartered, JPMorgan, Deutsche, Barclays, Societe Generale and dozens of KPO/BPO shops (WNS, Genpact, TCS, Cognizant, HPE-adjacent operations) run thousands of KYC seats out of Mumbai, Bangalore, Pune, Chennai and Gurgaon. It sits inside Operations / Financial Crime Compliance, not front office. The ladder typically runs Analyst / KYC Analyst -> Senior Analyst -> Team Lead / SME (Subject Matter Expert) -> Assistant Manager / QC -> Manager -> AVP. It is a stable, learnable, high-headcount role — and you should be clear-eyed that the entry rungs are process-heavy and pay modestly.

What you'll actually do

Your day is casework: you build or refresh a KYC file for a client (often a corporate, a fund, or a trust) and get it to "clean" status inside a Service Level Agreement (SLA).

- Create and validate KYC records: collect and verify identity documents, incorporation papers, board resolutions, and registration proofs (CIP — Customer Identification Program).
- Perform CDD (Customer Due Diligence) for standard clients and EDD (Enhanced Due Diligence) for high-risk ones — high-risk jurisdictions, cash-intensive businesses, complex ownership.
- Unwrap ownership and control: map the UBO (Ultimate Beneficial Owner) chain, directors, and management structure through layered entities.
- Screen names against sanctions lists, PEP databases and adverse/negative news (using Dun & Bradstreet, World-Check, LexisNexis, and open regulatory sites); triage and escalate true hits.
- Escalate negative-news and suspicious patterns; contribute to SAR/STR (Suspicious Activity / Transaction Report) drafting where you sit on the AML/transaction-monitoring side.
- Work to hard SLAs and quality (QC) targets — throughput and error rate are both measured.

Real posting (Citi): "Create and validate KYC records, CIP documentation, ownership/management structure, screening via Dun & Bradstreet and regulatory sites, negative-news escalation, within SLAs."

Must-have skills

- Attention to detail — a missed UBO or a wrong risk rating is an audit finding.
- Reading and interpreting corporate documents across jurisdictions.
- Clear written English — case notes and rationales must survive audit and regulator review.
- Judgement on true vs false screening hits; comfort escalating rather than clearing.
- Understanding of AML typologies, sanctions regimes (OFAC), and the PMLA / RBI KYC framework in India.

- Speed under SLA without dropping quality; ability to sit with repetitive casework.

Tools & software

World-Check (Refinitiv), Dun & Bradstreet, LexisNexis, Bridger / Fircosoft or Actimize (screening & transaction monitoring), the bank's KYC workflow platform (e.g. Fenargo, Pega), MS Excel, and regulatory / registry sites (MCA21, sanctions lists, SEBI/RBI). Some AML analytics roles touch SQL or dashboards, but entry KYC is largely platform + document work.

Qualifications & certifications

A bachelor's degree is enough to start — B.Com, BBA, BA, and notably a law background is welcomed for CDD/EDD reasoning. The one credential that genuinely moves you here is **CACS/ACAMS** — the CAMS (Certified Anti-Money Laundering Specialist) certification from ACAMS is the recognised badge and helps at the Senior Analyst -> SME -> AVP transition and for switching employers at a premium. NISM and CA/MBA are *not* what this role rewards; CAMS is. An LLB is a real asset for financial-crime and sanctions work.

Experience & typical titles

Band	Typical titles
Fresher / 0-1 yr	KYC Analyst, Onboarding Analyst, AML Analyst, Client Data Analyst
1-3 yrs	Senior KYC Analyst, CDD/EDD Analyst, QC Analyst, SME
4-7 yrs	Team Lead, Assistant Manager, Financial Crime Compliance Manager, AVP

Most postings for the door role ask 1-3 years, but a large share of seats are genuinely fresher-friendly campus/lateral hires trained in-house.

ATS keywords to mirror

KYC, AML, CDD, EDD, CIP, Customer Due Diligence, Enhanced Due Diligence, UBO, beneficial ownership, sanctions screening, PEP screening, negative news, adverse media, World-Check, Dun & Bradstreet, transaction monitoring, SAR, STR, PMLA, FATF, OFAC, financial crime compliance, client onboarding, periodic review, SLA, ACAMS/CAMS.

Salary in India (indicative, FY2026)

Experience band	Indicative CTC (Rs LPA)
Fresher / 0-1 yr	3.0 – 5.0
2-4 yrs	5.0 – 9.0
5-8 yrs (TL / AM / AVP)	10 – 20

Approximate and varies by city and employer; foreign-bank GCCs (Citi, HSBC, SocGen) and night-shift roles pay at the higher end, KPO/BPO shops at the lower. Numbers are indicative FY2026 ranges.

Who's hiring

Foreign-bank GCCs and captives: **Citi**, HSBC, Standard Chartered, JPMorgan, Deutsche Bank, Barclays, Societe Generale, BNP Paribas. KPO/BPO and consulting: WNS, Genpact, TCS, Cognizant, Infosys BPM, EXL. Hubs: Mumbai, Bangalore, Pune, Chennai, Gurgaon, Hyderabad. This is one of the highest-headcount hiring categories in Indian financial services.

How to break in / stand out

This is the most *accessible* finance job in India, which is exactly why you must differentiate to avoid being stuck on the volume treadmill.

1. **Learn the vocabulary before the interview.** Be able to explain CDD vs EDD, what a UBO is, how you'd triage a sanctions hit, and what makes a client high-risk. Interviewers screen hard for people who actually understand *why* KYC exists (regulatory + reputational risk) versus people who just want a bank job.
2. **Build a mock KYC case file.** Take a real listed company, pull its MCA/annual-report data, map the ownership chain and directors, run open-source adverse-media checks, and write a one-page CDD memo with a risk rating and rationale. Bring it. Almost no fresher does this, and it instantly signals you can do the actual work.
3. **Get CAMS on your radar early** — even "CAMS in progress" on the resume separates you and is the clearest path off the entry rung toward SME and AVP pay.
4. **Be honest with yourself about the ladder.** The entry work is repetitive and metric-driven. The winners treat it as a two-year launchpad: master EDD and sanctions, get CAMS, and pivot into Financial Crime Compliance, transaction monitoring, or a Compliance/Regulatory seat where the pay curve steepens.

The single biggest differentiator: demonstrating **judgement** — showing you can decide when to clear a hit and when to escalate — rather than just claiming you're "detail-oriented."

Compliance & Regulatory Analyst

Snapshot

The Compliance & Regulatory Analyst is the person who makes sure the organisation does what the law and its regulators require — and can *prove* it did. Where the KYC analyst clears individual clients, the compliance analyst manages the institution's obligations as a whole: what has to be filed, by when, to whom, and with what evidence. In India this role lives against a dense regulatory backdrop — SEBI for capital markets, RBI for banking/NBFCs, IRDAI for insurance, MCA/Companies Act for corporates, and a thick layer of labour-law and statutory enactments (PF, ESI, PT, factory/shops acts, POSH). The role exists in banks, NBFCs, AMCs, brokers, insurers, listed companies, and — increasingly — in consulting/GCC shops that run compliance-as-a-service for clients. It sits inside Legal / Compliance / Company Secretary functions. The ladder runs Compliance Analyst / Executive -> Senior Analyst -> Assistant Manager -> Compliance Manager -> Head of Compliance / Chief Compliance Officer. It rewards people who are organised, calendar-driven, and comfortable reading a regulation and turning it into a checklist.

What you'll actually do

Your core deliverable is a compliance calendar that never slips and an audit trail that never has a gap.

- Own the compliance calendar and trackers: every filing, return, renewal and disclosure with due dates and owners.
- Prepare and submit regulatory filings under applicable enactments (labour-law returns, statutory filings, sector filings to SEBI/RBI/registrars).
- Monitor for regulatory change — new circulars, amendments, notifications — and assess what the organisation must do in response.
- Monitor and report compliance risks to management; maintain registers of breaches, gaps, and remediation.
- Support inspections and audits — internal, statutory, and regulator-led — by assembling evidence and responding to queries.
- Coordinate across HR, finance, legal and business teams to close compliance actions before deadlines.

Real posting (Accenture): "Maintain the compliance calendar and trackers, complete filings under labour-law enactments, support inspections/audits, and monitor and report compliance risks."

Must-have skills

- Reading a statute/circular and extracting the concrete obligation (what, when, format, penalty for missing).
- Ruthless organisation and follow-through — the calendar is the job.
- Strong written communication for filings, notes to management, and regulator responses.
- Working knowledge of the relevant regime: SEBI/RBI/IRDAI, Companies Act, or labour-law depending on the seat.

- Stakeholder chasing — most of your risk comes from other teams missing deadlines, so you must be able to push politely and persistently.
- Documentation and evidence discipline for audit-readiness.

Tools & software

MS Excel and MS Word (trackers, calendars, filings), compliance/GRC platforms where mature (e.g. tools like Avantis / ComplyRelax / Ricago / MetricStream for statutory compliance), regulatory portals (SEBI SCORES/intermediary portals, RBI filing systems, MCA21, EPFO/ESIC portals), and document/workflow systems. Much of the entry work is still Excel- and portal-driven.

Qualifications & certifications

A law background (LLB) or a commerce degree (B.Com/M.Com) is the common entry. The high-value credentials for a *compliance career* are **CS (Company Secretary)** — the natural fit for corporate/secretarial and listed-company compliance — and for financial-markets seats the **NISM** series plus a **Compliance Officer certification**. An LLB is a strong differentiator for regulatory interpretation. CA/CMA help where compliance overlaps with financial and tax filings. For AML-adjacent compliance, CAMS adds value. MBA-Finance helps for management-track progression more than for the technical work itself.

Experience & typical titles

Band	Typical titles
Fresher / 0-2 yrs	Compliance Analyst, Compliance Executive, Regulatory Analyst, Statutory Compliance Executive
2-4 yrs	Senior Compliance Analyst, Assistant Manager – Compliance, Regulatory Reporting Analyst
5-8 yrs	Compliance Manager, Regulatory Affairs Manager, Company Secretary (corporate)

ATS keywords to mirror

Regulatory compliance, compliance calendar, statutory compliance, regulatory filings, SEBI, RBI, IRDAI, Companies Act, labour law compliance, PF/ESI/PT, POSH, regulatory reporting, compliance monitoring, compliance risk, inspections, statutory audit support, regulatory change management, compliance tracker, filings, remediation, Company Secretary, NISM.

Salary in India (indicative, FY2026)

Experience band	Indicative CTC (Rs LPA)
Fresher / 0-2 yrs	3.5 – 6.0
2-4 yrs	6.0 – 11.0
5-8 yrs	11 – 22

Approximate and varies by city, sector and employer; regulated financial firms (banks, AMCs, brokers) and foreign GCCs pay above corporate/labour-law compliance seats. Indicative FY2026 ranges.

Who's hiring

Consulting/GCC and BPO: **Accenture**, Deloitte, EY, KPMG, PwC, Genpact. Financial firms: banks, NBFCs, AMCs, brokers, insurers, and fintechs building out compliance as they scale under RBI/SEBI scrutiny. Listed corporates across sectors need statutory/secretarial compliance. Hubs: Bangalore, Mumbai, Gurgaon, Pune, Hyderabad.

How to break in / stand out

1. **Pick a regime and go deep.** "Compliance" is too broad to be hireable — decide whether you're the SEBI/RBI financial-markets person, the corporate/secretarial (CS) person, or the labour-law/statutory person, and build genuine depth in one. Interviewers test whether you actually know the filings for your chosen regime.
2. **Build a compliance calendar as a portfolio piece.** Take a hypothetical listed NBFC or a mid-size manufacturer and build a real annual compliance calendar — every SEBI/RBI/Companies-Act/labour-law obligation, due date, form number, and owner. This is exactly the deliverable you'd own on day one, and showing you can produce it is worth more than any certificate at the entry level.
3. **Read circulars for fun and summarise them.** Keeping a running one-line summary of recent SEBI/RBI circulars (and what they oblige firms to do) signals the single most important skill: turning regulation into action.
4. **Layer the right cert.** For the corporate track, pursue CS. For the markets track, do NISM + the Compliance Officer module. An LLB is a durable edge for interpretation-heavy seats.

The single biggest differentiator: proving you can **translate a regulation into a concrete, dated, evidenced action plan** — not just cite that a rule exists. Compliance is judged on zero missed deadlines and clean audits, and hiring managers look for candidates who already think in calendars and evidence trails.

GRC / IT Risk Analyst

Snapshot

The GRC (Governance, Risk & Compliance) / IT Risk Analyst is the crossover role where finance-style risk discipline meets information security. Instead of managing credit or market risk, you manage the risk that the organisation's *systems, data, and vendors* fail a control, a regulation, or a customer's security expectations. This is the natural home for a CS-leaning or commerce-plus-tech candidate: it doesn't require you to write production code, but it does require you to understand how controls work and to speak the language of both auditors and engineers. The role exists in fintechs, SaaS companies, banks, IT services, consulting firms, and any company that has to answer "are you secure?" to customers and regulators. It sits inside Information Security / Risk / Internal Audit. The ladder runs GRC/IT Risk Analyst -> Senior Analyst / Consultant -> GRC Lead / Manager -> Head of GRC / Information Security Manager -> CISO-track. Demand is rising fast as Indian fintechs face RBI cyber-security norms and as every SaaS vendor is forced through SOC 2 and ISO 27001 to close enterprise deals.

What you'll actually do

Your work is turning security policy into evidence — maintaining the registers, mappings, and answers that prove the company's controls actually operate.

- Maintain the risk register: identify, rate, and track IT/security risks and their treatment/remediation.
- Map controls to frameworks — ISO/IEC 27001, SOC 2 (Trust Services Criteria), NIST CSF, PCI-DSS, RBI/CERT-In guidelines — and evidence that each control operates.
- Run vendor / third-party risk assessments: review suppliers' security posture before and during engagements (TPRM).
- Complete customer security questionnaires and RFP security sections (CAIQ, SIG, bespoke enterprise questionnaires).
- Support internal, external, and certification audits — assemble evidence, coordinate auditors, and track findings to closure.
- Assist with policy documentation, access reviews, and control-gap remediation across engineering and IT teams.

Real posting (KPMG / GRC seen): "Maintain risk registers, map ISO 27001 / SOC 2 controls, run third-party/vendor risk assessments, complete security questionnaires, and support audit engagements."

Must-have skills

- Understanding of security control frameworks (ISO 27001 Annex A, SOC 2 TSC) — not just their names, but what a control *does*.
- Risk assessment method: likelihood x impact, treatment options, residual risk.
- Reading evidence critically — a screenshot or log that actually proves a control works vs one that doesn't.
- Clear writing for questionnaires, risk notes, and audit responses.
- Stakeholder coordination with engineering, IT, and legal to close gaps.

- Basic technical literacy: access controls, encryption, logging, cloud (AWS/Azure) concepts, SDLC — enough to hold a credible conversation with engineers.

Tools & software

GRC / compliance-automation platforms: Vanta, Drata, Sprinto (big in Indian fintech/SaaS), plus enterprise tools like MetricStream, Archer, ServiceNow GRC. Cloud consoles (AWS/Azure/GCP) for evidence, ticketing (Jira), SIEM/log tooling awareness, and MS Excel for registers and mappings. Familiarity with a questionnaire standard (CAIQ/SIG) is a plus.

Qualifications & certifications

A degree in commerce, CS/IT, or a related field works — this role prizes certifications over a specific degree. The credentials that genuinely help here: **ISO 27001 Lead Auditor / Lead Implementer** (the most directly relevant, and achievable early), **CISA** (Certified Information Systems Auditor — the gold standard for IT audit/risk), and later **CRISC** or **CISM**. **CISSP** signals depth for senior seats. Cloud fundamentals (AWS Cloud Practitioner) help credibility. Traditional finance certs (CA/CFA/FRM) matter less here — this is where the CS/finance crossover candidate should invest in security certs instead.

Experience & typical titles

Band	Typical titles
Fresher / 0-2 yrs	GRC Analyst, IT Risk Analyst, Information Security Analyst, Compliance Analyst (InfoSec)
2-4 yrs	Senior GRC Analyst, IT Risk Consultant, Security Compliance Specialist, TPRM Analyst
5-8 yrs	GRC Lead / Manager, Information Security Manager, IT Audit Manager

ATS keywords to mirror

GRC, IT risk, information security, ISO 27001, ISO 27001 Lead Auditor, SOC 2, NIST CSF, PCI-DSS, risk register, controls mapping, third-party risk, vendor risk management, TPRM, security questionnaire, CAIQ, SIG, audit support, evidence collection, remediation, access review, CISA, Vanta, Drata, Sprinto, RBI cyber security, CERT-In.

Salary in India (indicative, FY2026)

Experience band	Indicative CTC (Rs LPA)
Fresher / 0-2 yrs	4.0 – 7.0
2-4 yrs	7.0 – 14.0
5-8 yrs	14 – 28

Approximate and varies by city and employer; product SaaS/fintech and Big-4 consulting pay above IT-services shops, and certified candidates (ISO 27001 LA, CISA) command a clear premium. Indicative FY2026 ranges — GRC pays noticeably better than generic finance-compliance because of the security scarcity.

Who's hiring

Fintech/SaaS: **Digitap** and peers, plus the broad Indian SaaS cohort chasing SOC 2 / ISO 27001.

Consulting/audit: **KPMG**, Deloitte, EY, PwC (IT-risk and cyber practices). Product/enterprise: **3M** and other MNC captives, banks, and NBFCs building GRC teams under RBI norms. Tooling vendors (Vanta/Drata/Sprinto ecosystem) also hire GRC talent. Hubs: Bangalore, Hyderabad, Pune, Gurgaon, Mumbai.

How to break in / stand out

1. **Learn one framework cold.** Pick ISO 27001 (Annex A controls) or SOC 2 (the five Trust Services Criteria) and be able to explain, for five real controls, what the control requires and what evidence proves it operates. This single skill separates credible candidates from résumé keyword-stuffers.
2. **Build a controls-mapping portfolio piece.** Take a hypothetical fintech and produce a mini risk register plus an ISO 27001 or SOC 2 controls matrix — control, owner, status, evidence, gap. This is literally the day-one deliverable, and showing it beats any bootcamp certificate.
3. **Get ISO 27001 Lead Auditor early**, then target CISA as the career-defining cert. "ISO 27001 LA + CISA in progress" is the fastest CV signal in this field.
4. **Speak both languages.** Your value is being the person who can sit between auditors and engineers. Practise explaining a control to a non-technical auditor *and* asking an engineer for the right evidence without annoying them.

The single biggest differentiator: being able to **judge whether a piece of evidence actually satisfies a control** — the judgement that turns a checklist-filler into a real GRC professional, and the reason this crossover role out-earns generic compliance seats.

Private Equity / VC Analyst

Snapshot

A Private Equity (PE) or Venture Capital (VC) Analyst sits on the buy-side — the people who deploy investors' capital into private companies rather than trading public stocks. In India this splits two ways. There's the **investment/deal side** (sourcing, diligence, valuation, IC memos) at funds like Blackstone, KKR, ChrysCapital, Kedaara, Multiples, Sequoia/Peak XV, Accel, Elevation; and there's the **fund-services / valuation & reporting side** — the engine room that keeps the fund's books, values portfolios, and reports to Limited Partners (LPs). Much of that second half is done out of India for global funds by firms like **Acuity Knowledge Partners** and the **World Bank / IFC PE teams for South Asia**, plus the big fund administrators (State Street, Apex, Citco).

The ladder on the deal side runs Analyst -> Associate -> Sr Associate/VP -> Principal -> Partner. On the fund-reporting/valuation side it's Analyst -> Sr Analyst -> Team Lead/AVP -> Manager. This chapter grounds itself in the fund-valuation and investor-reporting reality (the doors most graduates actually get through) while telling you honestly what the deal seat demands.

What you'll actually do

On the fund-services / valuation & reporting side (the Acuity / World Bank PE evidence):

- Prepare **fund valuations** — mark portfolio holdings each quarter using comparable-company multiples, DCF, or last-round pricing, with a defensible bridge for every change.
- Maintain **capital accounts** for each LP: commitments, drawdowns/capital calls, distributions, and remaining **unfunded** commitment.
- Compute and reconcile **performance metrics** — **IRR, TVPI, DPI, RVPI and NAV** — at both the fund and deal level.
- Track **portfolio-company KPIs** (revenue, EBITDA, cash runway, covenant headroom) and roll them into a portfolio monitoring pack.
- Build the **quarterly investor reports** and capital-account statements LPs receive.
- Support diligence on live deals: data-room review, financial-statement spreading, and building/checking the LBO or growth-equity model.

Real posting (Acuity Knowledge Partners / World Bank PE South Asia): "Prepare fund valuations, capital accounts, commitments and unfunded; compute IRR/TVPI/DPI/NAV and portfolio KPIs; produce quarterly investor reports."

On the deal side add: sourcing and screening targets, industry theses, management-meeting notes, and drafting the **Investment Committee (IC) memo**.

Must-have skills

- **Financial modelling** — LBO, growth-equity, and DCF models built cleanly from scratch; you must understand the maths behind IRR and cash-on-cash, not just pull it from a template.

- **Fund waterfall & economics literacy** — carry, hurdle rate, catch-up, management fee, and how a distribution waterfall actually splits cash between LPs and the GP.
- **Financial-statement analysis** — spreading three statements, normalising EBITDA, spotting aggressive accounting.
- **Valuation** — trading comps, transaction comps, DCF, and the judgement to pick the right one for an illiquid private asset.
- **Precision and ownership** — LP reporting is scrutinised; a wrong NAV or IRR is a reputational event.
- Soft skills: discretion, stamina, and clear written communication (the memo is the product).

Tools & software

Category	Tools named in postings
Data & screening	Capital IQ (CapIQ), Preqin , PitchBook, Bloomberg
Modelling	Excel (advanced — you live here)
Fund admin / accounting	eFront, Investran, Allvue, Zoho/SAP for portfolio books
Reporting	PowerPoint, Power BI/Tableau for portfolio dashboards

CapIQ and Preqin are the two names that recur — CapIQ for comps and company data, Preqin for fund and LP benchmarking.

Qualifications & certifications

- **MBA-Finance** from a top school is the classic deal-side ticket; it's near-mandatory for associate roles at brand-name funds.
- **CFA** is the strongest signal for the valuation/reporting seat and is genuinely respected across the buy-side — Levels I–II show you can value assets.
- **CA** is a real edge on the fund-accounting, valuation and diligence side (you already read financials fluently).
- **CAIA** (Chartered Alternative Investment Analyst) is the specialist cert for alternatives — niche but a clean differentiator for a PE/VC-only career.
- **FMVA** helps a fresher demonstrate modelling but does not substitute for an MBA/CA/CFA at the door.

Which actually helps: for the Acuity-style reporting door, **CFA or CA + strong Excel**. For a fund's deal team, **MBA-Finance (tier-1) or CA + CFA**.

Experience & typical titles

Band	Fund-services / reporting	Deal side
Fresher / 0–2 yrs	Analyst, Fund Reporting; PE Valuation Analyst	Rare direct entry; usually post-IB/consulting or top MBA
2–5 yrs	Sr Analyst, AVP – Fund Valuation	Associate
5–8 yrs	Manager, Portfolio Valuation	VP / Principal

Be honest: **direct fresher entry to a deal team is one of the narrowest doors in Indian finance**. Most deal analysts arrive via 2 years in investment banking, top-tier consulting (Bain/McKinsey/BCG), or a tier-1 MBA. The realistic and very respectable way in for a commerce/CA/CFA candidate is the **fund-valuation and investor-reporting seat at Acuity, a fund administrator, or a captive** — real PE exposure, and a proven bridge to the deal side later.

ATS keywords to mirror

Private equity, venture capital, fund valuation, capital accounts, commitments, unfunded commitment, capital call, distribution waterfall, IRR, TVPI, DPI, RVPI, NAV, carried interest, hurdle rate, LBO model, DCF, comparable company analysis, portfolio monitoring, KPI reporting, LP reporting, quarterly investor report, Capital IQ, Preqin, due diligence, investment committee memo, CFA, CAIA, MBA Finance.

Salary in India (indicative, FY2026)

Experience	Fund-services / reporting	Deal side (top funds)
Fresher (0–2 yrs)	Rs 7–12 LPA	Rs 18–30 LPA
2–4 yrs	Rs 12–22 LPA	Rs 30–55 LPA
5–8 yrs	Rs 22–40 LPA	Rs 55 LPA–1 Cr+ (incl. carry)

Deal-side comp is skewed heavily by **carried interest**, which shows up only after years and successful exits. Ranges are approximate and vary sharply by fund tier, city (Mumbai/Bangalore/Gurgaon), and whether it's a captive vs a marquee GP.

Who's hiring

- **Fund services / valuation / reporting:** Acuity Knowledge Partners, State Street, Apex Group, Citco, IFC/World Bank PE (South Asia), captives of global GPs.
- **Deal side:** Blackstone, KKR, Carlyle, ChrysCapital, Kedaara, Multiples, Peak XV (ex-Sequoia India), Accel, Elevation, Everstone, TVS Capital, growth funds and family offices.

How to break in / stand out

1. **Build a real fund model.** Take a listed proxy for a private target, build an LBO or growth-equity model, and derive a 5-year IRR/MOIC with a returns bridge (entry multiple, debt paydown, EBITDA growth, exit multiple). This one artefact separates you from every "interested in PE" applicant.
2. **Learn the waterfall cold.** Be able to explain, on a whiteboard, how Rs 100 of distribution splits across an 8% hurdle with 20% carry and full GP catch-up. Deal teams test this.
3. **Take the fund-reporting door seriously.** An Acuity/fund-admin valuation seat is not a consolation prize — it's real PE exposure that pays, teaches you the economics, and is a documented bridge to a deal team.
4. **Clear CFA Level I–II** while you apply; it's the single credential the buy-side respects most for a non-MBA.

Biggest differentiator: the ability to build a defensible valuation of an *illiquid* asset and walk an investment committee through why your number is right — judgement under uncertainty, not template-filling.

Wealth Manager / Relationship Manager / PMS

Snapshot

A Wealth Manager or Relationship Manager (RM) is the client-facing face of a bank, wealth firm, or Portfolio Management Service (PMS). You own a **book of clients** — mass-affluent, HNI (High Net Worth), or ultra-HNI — and your job is to grow the assets they hold with your firm (AUM), keep them invested through market noise, and sell them the right mix of products. This is a **revenue role**, not a back-office one: you carry targets, and your pay is heavily variable. The classic ladders are RM -> Sr RM -> Team Lead -> Cluster/Circle Head (bank branch banking), and for private wealth: Wealth Manager -> Sr Wealth Manager -> Private Banker -> Market Head. Grounded on the **DBS Treasures** wealth-RM and **branch RM** postings seen in India.

What you'll actually do

- **Manage and grow a client book** — deepen relationships with existing HNI/mass-affluent clients and acquire new ones, with an explicit **AUM growth / Net New Money** target.
- **Financial planning & portfolio reviews** — understand the client's goals, risk appetite and time horizon; run periodic reviews and rebalance.
- **Advise on product suitability** — mutual funds, PMS, AIFs, bonds, insurance, structured products, deposits — matched to the client's risk profile (this suitability check is a regulatory obligation, not a nicety).
- **Cross-sell and deepen** — bring in the family's other relationships, insurance, lending, and banking products.
- **Complete KYC and onboarding** cleanly, keep records audit-ready, and follow AML norms.
- **Hit sales targets** — revenue, AUM, product-mix and activity (calls/meetings) metrics, reviewed monthly.

Real posting (DBS Treasures): "Acquire and grow a portfolio of Treasures (HNI) clients, drive AUM and revenue growth, and provide need-based wealth solutions in line with the client's risk profile."

Must-have skills

- **Sales and relationship-building** — the core competency; you must be comfortable prospecting, asking for money, and holding a client through a market crash.
- **Product knowledge across the shelf** — MFs, PMS, AIFs, bonds, insurance, structured products; you can't advise on what you don't understand.
- **Suitability and risk profiling** — matching product to client, honestly.
- **Financial planning literacy** — goals, asset allocation, tax-efficiency basics.
- **Compliance discipline** — KYC/AML, and staying inside SEBI/RBI advice-vs-distribution boundaries.
- Soft skills: trust-building, resilience under targets, and the emotional intelligence to talk a nervous client off a ledge.

Tools & software

Category	Tools
CRM	Salesforce, in-house CRM, HubSpot
Portfolio / reporting	Bank wealth platforms, PMS reporting tools, MF platforms (BSE Star MF, MFU)
Market data	Bloomberg (private banking), Morningstar, Value Research
Everyday	Excel, PowerPoint for client reviews

Qualifications & certifications

- **NISM certifications are effectively mandatory** to advise and transact:
- **NISM Series V-A (Mutual Fund Distributors)** — the baseline to sell MFs.
- **NISM Series X-A and X-B (Investment Adviser Levels 1 & 2)** — for anyone giving investment advice under the SEBI RIA framework.
- **NISM Series XXI-A / XXI-B (PMS Distributors / Portfolio Managers)** — for the PMS side.
- **AMFI ARN** registration to distribute mutual funds.
- **Insurance:** IRDAI certification for insurance products.
- **MBA-Finance** is the common degree and helps at private-banking firms; **CFP (Certified Financial Planner)** is a genuine differentiator for advisory credibility; **CFA** is respected at the ultra-HNI/private-banking end.
- Which actually helps here: **NISM V-A + X-A/X-B (and PMS series if relevant) are non-negotiable to operate;** CFP/CFA lift you from "distributor" to "adviser".

Experience & typical titles

Band	Typical titles
Fresher / 0–2 yrs	Relationship Officer, Acquisition Manager, Jr RM
2–5 yrs	Relationship Manager, Wealth Manager, Sr RM
5–8 yrs	Private Banker, Team Lead, Sr Wealth Manager
8+ yrs	Cluster/Market Head, Circle Head – Wealth

Entry is accessible for a commerce/MBA-Finance graduate — banks hire in volume for acquisition roles. Moving up depends almost entirely on **whether you hit your numbers**.

ATS keywords to mirror

Wealth management, relationship management, HNI, ultra-HNI, mass affluent, AUM growth, net new money, portfolio review, asset allocation, product suitability, risk profiling, financial planning, cross-sell, mutual funds, PMS, AIF, structured products, insurance, KYC, AML, NISM V-A, NISM X-A, NISM X-B, AMFI ARN, CFP, client acquisition, revenue targets.

Salary in India (indicative, FY2026)

Experience	Fixed pay (Rs LPA)	Note
Fresher (0–2 yrs)	Rs 3.5–6 LPA	plus incentives
2–4 yrs	Rs 6–12 LPA	large variable component
5–8 yrs	Rs 12–25 LPA	private banking higher; incentive can rival fixed

Honest note on pay: the **variable/incentive portion is large and target-linked** — top performers earn well above the band, under-performers can be managed out. The fixed number alone understates a good RM and overstates a struggling one. Varies by city, segment (branch vs private wealth) and employer; approximate.

Who's hiring

Banks and wealth arms: **DBS Treasures**, HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank, Axis Bank, Kotak, IDFC First, IndusInd. Private wealth & broking: 360 ONE (ex-IIFL Wealth), Nuvama, Anand Rathi, ASK, Julius Baer India, Motilal Oswal, Edelweiss, Bajaj Finserv. PMS/AMC channels also hire distribution RMs.

How to break in / stand out

1. **Get NISM V-A and X-A/X-B done before you apply** — walking in already certified signals you can produce revenue on day one and removes the firm's onboarding friction.
2. **Build a mock financial plan** for a hypothetical HNI family — goals, risk profile, asset allocation, product recommendations with suitability rationale. Bring it to the interview; it proves you think like an adviser, not just a salesperson.
3. **Be honest with yourself about the sales reality.** This role rewards people who genuinely enjoy relationships and can carry a target without burning out. If that's you, it pays and promotes fast.
4. **Pick a segment and specialise** — NRI clients, business-owner families, or professionals — a focused niche builds referrals faster than a scattergun book.

Biggest differentiator: a **book of trust**. Clients don't move crores to a person they don't believe in. The RMs who win are the ones who advise honestly through a down market and keep clients invested — that retention, not a slick pitch, is what compounds a career here.

Corporate Finance / M&A Analyst (in-house)

Snapshot

A Corporate Finance / M&A Analyst sits **inside a company** — in the corporate-development, strategy, or CFO's office team — rather than at a bank advising clients. Where an investment banker executes deals for a fee, you are the **principal**: you evaluate whether *your* company should acquire, invest, divest, or raise capital, and you build the case that goes to the board and the CEO. It's the seat that **bridges FP&A and investment banking** — you use the modelling rigour of IB but with the long-horizon, operating context of an insider. Typical ladders: Analyst -> Sr Analyst -> Manager – Corp Dev/Strategy -> AVP/Head of Strategy -> VP Corporate Development. Common at large corporates, unicorns, and PE-backed platforms building through acquisition.

What you'll actually do

- **Valuation and financial modelling** — DCF, comparable companies, precedent transactions, accretion/dilution, and merger models to value targets or the company's own business units.
- **Build business cases** — model the returns on a new plant, market entry, product line, or acquisition; pressure-test the assumptions.
- **M&A support** — screen and evaluate targets, run financial diligence alongside advisers, model synergies and integration, and help negotiate.
- **Fund-raising** — support equity/debt raises, prepare the information memorandum and financial projections, and manage lender/investor Q&A.
- **Board and management materials** — turn analysis into crisp board decks, investment memos, and strategy papers senior leaders actually decide on.
- **Cross-functional partnering** — work with FP&A on the numbers, legal on structure, and business heads on the operating reality.

Real posting (synthesised from in-house corp-dev / strategy JDs): "Build valuation and financial models, prepare business cases and board materials, and support M&A and fund-raising activities for the group."

Must-have skills

- **Advanced financial modelling** — clean, flexible three-statement, DCF and merger models built from scratch; the modelling bar is close to IB.
- **Valuation fluency** — knowing which method fits which decision and defending the output.
- **Business and strategic judgement** — you're not just crunching a target; you're deciding if it fits the company's strategy and can be integrated.
- **Storytelling with numbers** — distilling a 40-tab model into a three-slide recommendation a busy board can act on.
- **Commercial diligence instinct** — spotting where a business case is optimistic.

- Soft skills: stakeholder management across functions, discretion (deals are confidential), and calm under deadline.

Tools & software

Category	Tools
Modelling	Excel (advanced), PowerPoint
Data	Capital IQ, Bloomberg, PitchBook for comps and precedents
Planning / systems	SAP, Oracle, Anaplan, Hyperion (shared with FP&A)
Reporting	Power BI/Tableau for dashboards

Qualifications & certifications

- **MBA-Finance** (tier-1) is the most common entry credential — the strategy and corp-dev teams recruit heavily from B-schools.
- **CA** is highly valued — the accounting depth is a real edge in diligence, accretion/dilution and deal structuring.
- **CFA** signals strong valuation and investment judgement and pairs well with either of the above.
- **FMVA** helps a fresher prove modelling capability but is a supplement, not a substitute for MBA/CA/CFA.
- Which actually helps: **MBA-Finance or CA to get in the door; CFA to deepen valuation credibility.** Prior **investment banking or Big-4 transaction-advisory experience** is the single strongest lateral ticket.

Experience & typical titles

Band	Typical titles
Fresher / 0–2 yrs	Analyst – Corporate Finance / Strategy (often ex-IB or top MBA)
2–5 yrs	Sr Analyst, Manager – Corporate Development / Strategy
5–8 yrs	AVP – Corp Dev, Head of Strategy (BU)
8+ yrs	VP – Corporate Development, Director – Strategy

Direct fresher entry is competitive; many analysts arrive after **2–3 years in IB, Big-4 deals/valuation, or FP&A**. FP&A is a very realistic internal bridge into this seat — you already know the company's numbers.

ATS keywords to mirror

Corporate finance, corporate development, M&A, mergers and acquisitions, financial modelling, DCF, comparable company analysis, precedent transactions, accretion dilution, merger model, valuation, business case, feasibility, synergy analysis, due diligence, fund raising, capital raising, information memorandum, board presentation, investment memo, strategy, Capital IQ, Excel, PowerPoint, MBA Finance, CA, CFA.

Salary in India (indicative, FY2026)

Experience	Salary (Rs LPA)
Fresher (0–2 yrs)	Rs 10–18 LPA
2–4 yrs	Rs 18–35 LPA
5–8 yrs	Rs 35–60 LPA+

In-house corp-dev generally pays **better than FP&A and below front-office IB**, with more predictable hours than banking. Numbers vary by company size (unicorn vs large-cap), city, and whether ESOPs/bonus form part of the package; approximate.

Who's hiring

Large corporates and conglomerates (Reliance, Tata group, Aditya Birla, Adani, Mahindra), unicorns and late-stage startups building via M&A (Flipkart, Swiggy, Razorpay, PharmEasy-type platforms), PE-backed roll-up platforms, and the strategy/corp-dev arms of Big-4 (as a training ground). Companies with an active acquisition agenda are where the seat is busiest.

How to break in / stand out

1. **Build a full merger model.** Pick two listed Indian companies, model an acquisition — funding mix, synergies, accretion/dilution to EPS — and write a one-page board recommendation. This is the closest thing to the actual job and almost no applicant brings it.
2. **Use FP&A as a bridge.** If you can't enter directly, an FP&A seat at a company with an M&A agenda gets you the internal numbers and the relationships; then move to corp-dev.
3. **Think like an owner, not an adviser.** Interviewers want to hear "should we do this deal and can we integrate it?" — not just "here's the valuation." Strategic fit and integration risk are what set you apart.
4. **Clear CFA Level I–II** or lean on your CA to signal the valuation depth.

Biggest differentiator: the judgement to say **no** to a deal that models well but doesn't fit the strategy. In-house, protecting the company's capital matters more than closing a transaction — the analysts who show that instinct get trusted with bigger decisions fast.

Markets & Advisory Skills, Tools & Certification Matrix

This closing chapter pulls the markets-and-advisory roles from this section into one view — so you can see which skills carry across roles, which certification is actually worth your money, and exactly what to do in the next 90 days to be interview-ready for a front-office/markets seat. Use it as the map; the individual chapters are the detail.

Role × skill matrix

A quick-scan of what each role leans on. ●● = **core/daily**, ● = **useful**, – = **rarely needed**.

Role	Fin. modelling	Valuation	VaR / risk models	Bloomberg	Python	SQL	Excel	Credit analysis	AML/KYC
Investment Banking Analyst	●●	●●	–	●	●	●	●●	●	–
Equity Research Analyst	●●	●●	●	●●	●	●	●●	●	–
Credit Risk Analyst	●	●	●	●	●	●	●●	●●	●
Risk / Model Validation	●	●	●●	●●	●●	●●	●●	●	●
Treasury Analyst	●	●	●	●●	●	●	●●	●	●
KYC / AML Analyst	–	–	–	●	–	●	●●	●	●●
Private Equity / VC Analyst	●●	●●	●	●	●	●	●●	●	–
Wealth / RM / PMS	●	●	–	●	–	–	●●	●	●●
Corporate Finance / M&A (in-house)	●●	●●	–	●	●	●	●●	●	–

Read the columns, not just the rows: **Excel is universal**, **financial modelling + valuation** cluster the deal/advisory roles (IB, ER, PE, M&A), **VaR + Python + SQL** cluster the quant-risk roles (model validation, market risk), and **credit analysis + AML/KYC** cluster the banking/compliance roles.

Certification decoder

Which cert to actually spend money and a year of evenings on, by target role:

Certification	Best for	Effort / cost (indicative)	Verdict
CFA (3 levels, CFA Institute)	Equity research, PE/VC, asset mgmt, corp-dev, buy-side risk	~3–4 yrs, Rs 3–5 L all-in	The gold standard for investment/markets roles. Level I–II alone is a strong signal. Highest ROI for front-office.
FRM (2 parts, GARP)	Credit risk, market risk, model validation, treasury	~1.5–2 yrs, Rs 1.5–2.5 L	The risk-side gold standard. If risk is your lane, this beats CFA.
CQF (Certificate in Quantitative Finance)	Model validation, quant risk, derivatives	6 mths, Rs 8–12 L	Niche and pricey; only if you're genuinely going quant.
NISM series (SEBI)	Wealth/RM/PMS, broking, advisory, research (India-mandatory)	Weeks each, Rs 1.5–3k each	Cheap, fast, and <i>required</i> to operate in India. V-A (MF), X-A/X-B (Investment Adviser), XV (Research Analyst), XXI (PMS). Do the ones your role needs.
ACAMS (CAMS)	KYC/AML, financial-crime compliance	3–4 mths, Rs 1–1.5 L	The recognised AML credential; strong for a compliance-track career.
CAIA (2 levels)	PE/VC, alternatives, hedge funds	~1–1.5 yrs, Rs 2–3 L	Specialist alternatives cert; clean differentiator if PE/VC is the whole plan.

Rules of thumb: **markets/investing lane -> CFA; risk lane -> FRM; India distribution/advisory -> NISM (non-negotiable); financial crime -> ACAMS; alternatives-only -> CAIA**. Don't collect certs — pick the one that matches your target seat and finish it.

Universal ATS keyword bank (markets & advisory roles)

Mirror the ones true for your target role — never fake a skill:

Financial modelling, valuation, DCF, comparable company analysis, precedent transactions, LBO model, merger model, accretion dilution, three-statement model, equity research, initiating coverage, channel checks, target price, credit analysis, financial statement analysis, cash flow analysis, leverage, credit proposal, due diligence, VaR, model validation, model risk, market risk, time-series, Monte Carlo, portfolio management, asset allocation, IRR, TVPI, NAV, capital markets, M&A, fund raising, treasury, FX, derivatives, money markets, KYC, AML, sanctions screening, Bloomberg, Refinitiv, Capital IQ, Preqin, Python, SQL, VBA, Power BI, Excel, PowerPoint, CFA, FRM, NISM, board presentation, investment memo.

90-day plan to be interview-ready (front-office / markets)

Days 1–30 — Foundations & the anchor skill. - Master **Excel to modelling standard**: shortcuts (no mouse), clean formatting, INDEX/MATCH, data tables, and a full **three-statement model built from scratch** (not a template). - Register for **CFA Level I** (or **FRM Part I** if risk is your lane) — start studying now; even "candidate" status is a resume signal. - Read one company's annual report end-to-end and learn to spread its financials.

Days 31–60 — Build the portfolio piece. - Pick one listed Indian company and produce a **complete equity research note or valuation** — model, target price, and a two-page thesis. This single artefact beats any bullet point. - Learn **Bloomberg/Capital IQ basics** (many campuses and libraries have terminals) and pull comps. - If targeting risk/quant: build a **VaR calculation in Python** on a small portfolio and document the method. - Clear the **NISM series** your target role legally needs (fast and cheap).

Days 61–90 — Sharpen, network, apply. - Do a **second modelling piece** in a different sector, or an LBO/merger model if you're PE/M&A-bound. - Drill **valuation and technical interview questions** out loud (WACC, why DCF vs comps, what moves a bond price, how VaR works). - **Network deliberately** — 10 informational conversations with people one rung ahead; front-office seats are filled through referrals as much as portals. - Rewrite your resume to **mirror the ATS keywords** for your one target role, attach the portfolio link, and apply in focused batches — not scattershot.

The one thing that matters most: a real, self-built analytical artefact — a model, a research note, a valuation — that you can defend live. Certifications get you past the filter; the artefact and the ability to defend your numbers get you the offer.